



FREE GUIDE · FOR GROUP HOMES

The Group Home's Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Resident medication take-back — including controls —
done safely and documented.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Resident meds, handled right.

Group homes and residential care settings manage resident medications — including controlled substances — that need safe, documented take-back and destruction when discontinued, expired, or after a resident leaves. Add occasional sharps and you have real regulated waste. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor gives you a simple, documented way to destroy resident medications and controls — mail-back or on-site deactivation — plus sharps, with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Resident controlled substances — discontinued, expired, or left behind.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Unused resident Schedule II–V meds
- Discontinued controlled orders
- Wasted doses

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs; on-site deactivation meets non-retrievable guidance.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled / medication mail-back kit, or on-site deactivation, to DEA standards.

Tip

On-site deactivation lets you render controls non-retrievable immediately — useful when meds shouldn't leave the building.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste

Resident non-controlled medication returns.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired resident meds
- Discontinued medications
- Non-controlled returns

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit or on-site deactivation.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 03

Sharps

Insulin and injection sharps for residents who need them.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Insulin pens & needles
- Injection syringes
- Lancets

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The group home compliance checklist.

- ☐ Resident controls rendered non-retrievable (mail-back or on-site) with Form 41.
- ☐ Resident non-controlled med returns destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Insulin and injection sharps in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ A documented medication take-back process.
- ☐ Staff trained on safe medication disposal.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS GROUP HOMES ASK

Your group home questions, answered.

How do we dispose of a resident's leftover controlled medications?

Render them non-retrievable — mail-back or on-site deactivation — and document with a DEA Form 41.

Can staff deactivate meds on-site?

Yes — on-site deactivation kits let staff render medications non-retrievable safely and immediately.

What about insulin sharps?

In an FDA-cleared sharps container and a prepaid sharps mail-back kit.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY**Handle it with mail-back.**

Easy Rx Cycle gives group homes on-site deactivation kits for resident medications and controls, plus prepaid mail-back kits for sharps — all destroyed compliantly with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Resident controls	On-site deactivation or controlled mail-back (Form 41)
Resident med returns	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Insulin / injection sharps	Sharps mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Most group homes do fine with mail-back and on-site kits. Larger operators may want scheduled pickup — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY GROUP HOMES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your group home waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop